

PANGTHANG NON-WOOD FOREST PRODUCT MANAGEMENT PLAN



WANGPHU GEWOG

(1st Revision)

Plan Period 2023-2028



DoFPS/FRPMD/NWFP-01/2023/ 293

28/09/2023

NOTESHEET

Subject: Approval of NWFP Management and Marketing Plans

The Non-Wood Forest Products are an important source of livelihood for many rural communities in the country. In order to ensure the sustainable management of resources in the wild, management responsibilities are handed over to the communities through the formation of Non-wood Forest Product Management and Marketing Group. Further, it is mandatory for the group to prepare a resource management and marketing plan and submit it for approval through the Chief Forestry Officer of that area.

As such the Forest Resource Planning and Management Division had received and reviewed the following plans submitted and hereby submitted to seek approval:

1. Barzor NWFP Management and Marketing Group, Gomdar Gewog, Samdrup Jongkhar Dzongkhag
2. Denchi NWFP Management and Marketing Group, Gomdar Gewog, Samdrup Jongkhar Dzongkhag
3. Pangthang NWFP Management and Marketing Group, Wamphu Gewog, Samdrup Jongkhar Dzongkhag

As per Chapter 7, Section 143 of the Forest and Nature Conservation Act of Bhutan 2023, the Department shall approve the Non-Wood Forest Product Management and Marketing Plans.

Submitted by:


(Sonam Tobgay)
Chief Forestry Officer

Remarks:

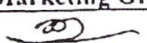

(Lobzang Dorji)
DIRECTOR

APPROVAL SHEET

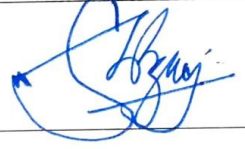
APPROVAL SHEET

Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group:	Pangthang NWFP Management and Marketing Group
Dzongkhag:	Samdrup Jongkhar
Gewog:	Wangphu
Village(s):	Barzor and Fremi
No. of households:	69
Area (ha)	150ha
Plan Period:	2023-2028

Prepared and submitted for approval

	NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Gewog Administration	Social Forestry Section Head	Head of the Division/Park
Signature				
Name	Tshewang Duba	Sangay Tenzin	Wangchuk	Sangay Dorjee
Title	Chair Person	Gup	Sec. PR.	CFO.

REVIEWED AND RECOMMENDED FOR APPROVAL

	Reviewing Officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Signature		
Name	Kerang Wangmo	
Position Title	By CFO	

APPROVED BY



DIRECTOR
Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

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Section A: NWFP Management and Marketing Plan

1. Background

The Panthang village under Wangphu Geog is located 11 km away from the gewog center. The community initiated and formed a Non-wood Forest Management group (NWFP) in 2017 with administrative and technical support from gewog administration and Department of Forest and Park Services. In 2017, the NWFP group of Pangthang comprises of 30 household from the community and managed for last five years. With the revision of plan in 2023 more members joined the group and at present there are 67 household registered as members.

The communities of Pangthang village depend on subsistence agriculture activities. The main food crop cultivated in the area is maize along with vegetables like potato, beans and chilli. They also grow cash crop like Ginger and Orange which in return provided them with good income for the family in a year.

The management plan for NWFP was developed in consultation with the community of Pangthang Village to guide the members to protect, and sustainably manage the NWFP resources found available in surrounding forest area. The Non-wood forest management plan extends a variety of long-term goals, strategies, and priorities to protect the forest resources. The forest is extensively used for timber, firewood, and fodder collection. NWFPs are collected for self-consumption and for marketing.

2. The traditional rights over natural resources

In the past there was no control of forest resources by the community of Pangthang and people from anywhere can come and collect the forest resources. With the increasing number of people collecting forest produces especially the NWFP products, the scarcity of the products was felt by the community and discussed to form a non-wood forest product management group. However, with the successful formation of the non-wood forest product management group in 2017, the community got the right to control and prevent outsiders from collecting NWFP products from the area.

The efficient implementation of management plan by group ensured a sustainable harvesting and use of NWFP resources. The members were able to harvest the NWFPs from their vicinity and market the products and generate income in the group.

3. Objectives

- Ensure sustainable harvesting of NWFP products
- To generate income through sale of NWFP products
- Protect from illegal harvesting

4. Review and achievement of previous management plan period

The five-year plan period for Pangthang Non-Wood Forest Product Management plan completed in 2023 after successful management by the group. The reviewing team found that the groups sustainably use the NWFP products for their own use and also for income generation. But with the Pandemic in 2020-2021, the group members were not able to perform the activities as expected. The group also could not market much of their NWFP products which affected the income generation in the group. The members were able to conduct few activities as follows:

- ✓ NWFPS mgt group meetings
- ✓ Patrolling in NWFP harvesting area
- ✓ Marketing of few NWFP species

5. Financial achievement

During the 5-year plan period the group marketed *Rubia cordifolia*, *Pouzolzia* sp and ferns. The management group has generated Nu.10000 from the sale of these products.

6. Problems and challenges

- ✓ Limited NWFP resources in the area.
- ✓ No proper marketing channel to sell the products
- ✓ Low price for the products by traders
- ✓ Long distance to market from source

7. Description of NWFPs

There are around nine different species of NWFPs found in Pangthang Non-wood Forest product management area. The species include Mushrooms, ferns, *Elastostema*, *Rubia cordifolia*, *Pouzolzia* sp, *Daphne*, *Chirata*, *Paris polyphylla* and *Viscum album*. The detail description of the products and their harvesting practices are mentioned in the table below:

Table 1. Brief description on NWFPs for commercial harvesting

NWFP name	Harvesting area	Parts used	Use purpose (traditional & other	Harvesting season (month)	Estimated quantity that can be collected
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i> (Damuru)	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Stem and leaves	Vegetable	Apr-Sept	500 bundles
Fern	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Shoot	Vegetable	Apr-Sept	2000 bundles

<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> (Laniru)	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Entire part	dyes (color)	Nov-Feb	500 kg
<i>Paris polyphylla</i> (Thoksampa)	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Rhizome	Medicine	Oct-Nov	50 kg
<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp (Yongiba)	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Bark	Adhesive, Incense	Aug-Feb	500 kg
Mushroom	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Entire part	Vegetable	Apr-Sept	200 kg
<i>Daphne</i> spp	Thokstifu & Shefudaza	Bark	Traditional paper	Mar-June	500 kg
<i>Swertia chiraita</i> (Chirata)	Shokshi- Pangthang	Entire plant	Medicinal	Nov-Jan	200 kg
<i>Viscum album</i>	Thokshiphu	Twigs	Ingredient / tea	Sept-Feb	30 kg
Borinda grossa	Shefudaza	Stem	Fencing sections, mats for house roofing	Dec-Feb	500 Nos

8. Prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting

The members of Pangthang non-wood forest management group will strictly follow the guidelines and management prescription prepared in the table below to ensure sustainable utilization of resources and to promote natural regeneration. The species not listed in this plan and if found abundant in the area will also be harvested as per the Forestry Act and Rules.

Table 2. Management prescription for NWFP harvesting

NWFP species	Harvesting prescription for sustainable harvesting
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	• Collect plants that are 15cm and above or matured ones. • Retain stump of around 3'' for sprouting of new shoots. • Do not uproot whole plant. • Should not cut down trees and create more opening. • Should not disturb its catchment area.
Fern	• Harvest only young shoot that are 15 cm long • Do not harvest the entire shoot coming up in season • Do not harvest the shoots that have developed to leaves. • Do not cut down trees which provide shade to plant

	• Retain at least 50% of young shoot of last flush for development of leaves
Laniru (<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>)	• Use sharp scissors for the collection of the upper part of the plant. • Cut the plant at 5 cm above ground level. • Leave at least 10% of the plants without collecting for next time regeneration purposes • Do not collect roots • Do not uproot entire plants
Thoksampa (<i>Paris polyphylla</i>)	• Harvest the rhizome after seed dispersal • Collect between Oct- Nov (most appropriate time to emerge bud from the rhizome which remains dormant underground till next germination period) • Leave some portion of Rhizome with bud underground while harvesting.
Yongdiba (<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp)	• Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level • Do not damage the remaining young stands/seedlings/saplings • Felling of surrounding trees to ease harvesting is prohibited • Leave at least 10% of the plants to allow natural regeneration • Harvesting of roots is strictly prohibited for ecological reason
Mushroom	• Do not uproot entire plant • Collect only mature one leaving young one • Harvest carefully
<i>Borinda grossa</i>	• Do not harvest during 12th – 8th of Bhutanese month. • Do not cut the culms less than one year old (retain immature) • Cut the culms above one node from the ground level • Cut the culms of three years and older • Do not harvest young shoot for sale purposes. • Follow rest of prescriptions steps from interim framework guide book for management and marketing of NWFPs.
<i>Daphne</i> spp.	• Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level • Cut only the stems that are 10 cm in diameter • Do not damage the remaining young stands/seedlings/saplings • Do not fell the surrounding trees in order to clear the area to ease harvesting • Harvesting should be done on rotational basis, once in 5 years for every block.

<i>Swertia chirayita</i>	• Collect only after seed dispersal (generally in Nov) • Do not collect the plants in late season to avoid damaging the germination of new seedlings
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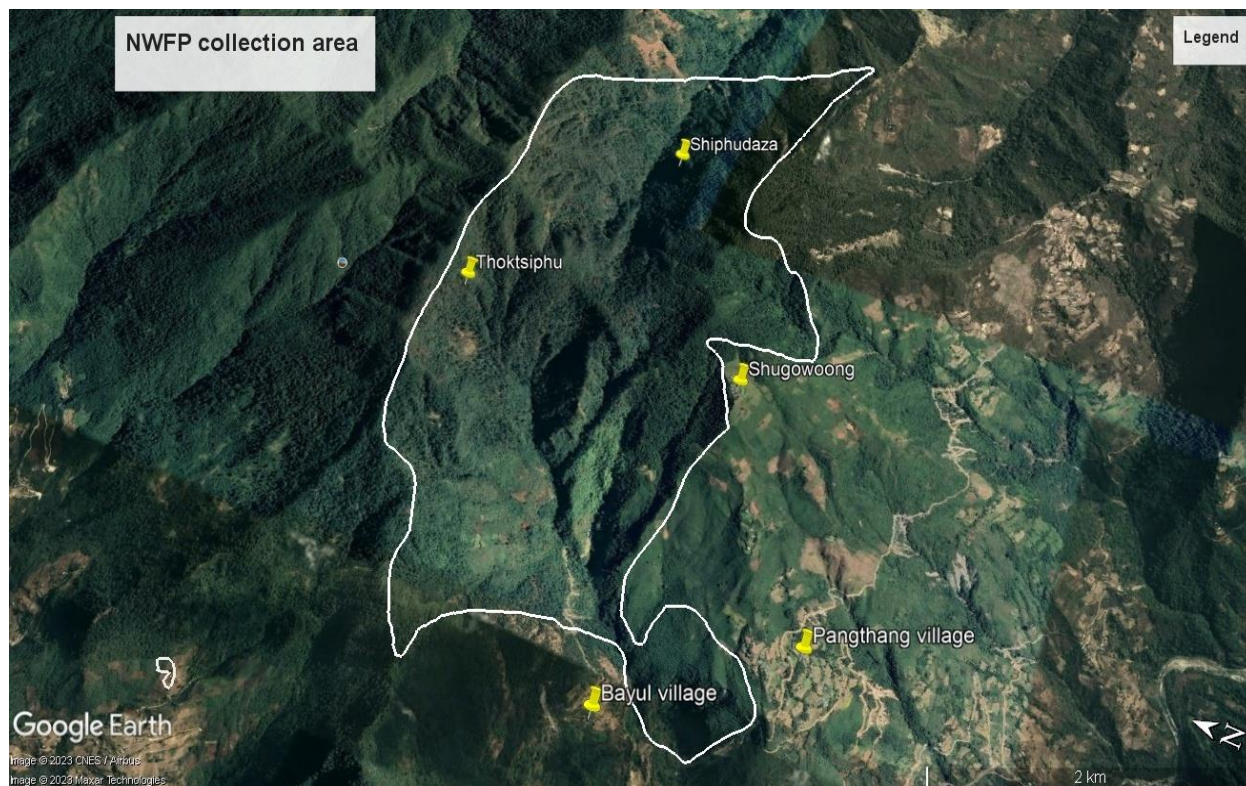


Figure 1. NWFP boundary map

9. Marketing and sales plan

The NWFP products will be sold to local markets and to the NWFP licence holder. If the products exceed demand in the market, the chairperson in consultation with gewog administration and forest officials will facilitate the marketing of excess products in collaboration with relevant stakeholders.

Table 3: Marketing and Sale plan for NWFPs products

NWFPs	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)	Expected selling price per unit (Nu)	Total (Nu)
<i>Elatostema lineolatum</i>	Local market/Samdrup Jongkhar town	400 bundles	Nu. 15/bundle	6000
Fern shoots	Samdrup Jongkhar town / Local market	500 bundles	Nu. 15/bundle	7500

<i>Paris polyphylla</i>	Samdrup Jongkhar town /NWFPs license holder	50 kg	Nu. 1000/Kg	50000
<i>Swertia chirayita</i>	NWFP license holder	200 kg	Nu. 50/kg	10000
Yongjibu (<i>Pouzolzia</i> spp.)	NWFPs license holder	300 kg	Nu.30/kg	9000
<i>Viscum album</i>	Local / SJ Throm/Narphung	50 kg	Nu.150/kg	7500
<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>	Samdrup Jongkhar Throm / NWFP license holder	500 kg	Nu.45/kg	22500
<i>Mushroom</i>	Local market	120 kg	100/kg	12000

9.1 Marketing arrangements

- Any NWFPs will be harvested as per the management prescription for sale with prior permission from the chairperson and the committee members.
- The quantity of product to be marketed will be first assessed by the chairperson and secretary to ensure proper recording and payment towards community fund
- The group members shall market their products individually or in group, whichever is convenient to them
- If there happen to be huge quantity of NWFPs for marketing, the group chairperson and committee members will seek support from the relevant stakeholders through Gewog Administration
- General consultation will be held upon call by chairperson and secretary to address issues related to marketing aspects and to fix any important program

9.2 Benefits to the members

- Any member can earn income through sale of NWFPs.
- All member has right to get equal share from the accumulated group fund.
- The group member shall be responsible to look after the welfare of incompetent member.

9.3 Benefits to the Group

- Sustainable harvesting guidelines and management plan in place.
- Easy access to permit for NWFPs harvesting and marketing
- Reduce illegal and unsustainable harvesting of NWFPs.
- Community development fund creation from the sale of NWFPs.

10. NWFPS HARVESTING CALENDER

Harvesting year	Name of Collecting area	Remarks
1 st Year	Shephu	Harvesting of products like ferns can be collected throughout the season as per management prescription
2 nd Year	Bayul-phu	
3 rd Year	Brangsa	
4 th Year	Bargoenpa	
5 th Year	Pangthangzor	

Section B: By-laws

11. Members of the NWFP management & marketing group

Village	Number of member households	Gewog
Bayul, Pangthang, Bargoenpa and Shoguwoong	67	Wangphu
a. Membership arrangement and rights of members ➤ Only the residents of Bayul, Pangthang, Bargoenpa & Shoguwoong with definite gung and census are eligible to become a member of NWFPS mgt. group. ➤ Each member will contribute sum of Nu.50 (fifty) as annual membership fee in the month of January every year. ➤ If he/she fragmented from same gung and wanted to become as separate new member can become a member after paying annual membership fee of Nu.50 (fifty) only. ➤ The person wishing to join the group must apply to chairperson. His/her membership would be decided by the group members during the general meeting and then make aware of group's objectives, plan and by-laws. ➤ The residents of same Chiwog who is not a member and later if he/she wants to become a member, can join after paying total annual membership fee and total fund accumulated for one member. ➤ Any member wishing to opt-out from membership due to genuine problem or reason (resettlement program) shall be entitled 50 percent of individual share from the common fund ➤ Any member on purposely withdraw from the group member shall not eligible for any benefits and forest resources from the NWFPS delineated areas base on the traditional boundaries. ➤ The members have right to terminate/re-elect the executive members if they misuse their responsibilities.		

b. Responsibilities of members:

- Active participation in meetings, trainings twice a year.
- All members should participate in protection, sustainable management and harvesting of NWFPs.
- The entire group member will actively participate in patrolling their NWFPs growing areas twice a year on rotational basis.
- Inform/avail permit from chairperson for collection of NWFPs and provide correct information for proper recording after marketing.
- Members must follow annual harvesting calendar.
- Harvest, manage and utilize the NWFPs on sustainable basis as per the management guidelines and prescriptions.
- Report promptly of any illegal encounter case to chairperson and committees for action

12. Executive committee and their roles and responsibilities

The 3 elected executive committee members will act as representatives of the NWFP Group pertaining to the management and utilization of the resources. The terms for these executive committee members were fixed for the period of five years without the incentives. However, they can resign or terminated before the completion of their terms if their performances are not satisfactory. The termination or resignation of executive committee will take place during the general assembly and the NWFP group members will approve the termination/resignation from the executive membership and nominate/elect the substitution through voting system.

	Name of Chairperson: Tshewang Duba
Chairperson	Responsibilities of Coordinator/Chairperson: ➤ Chair the meeting related to NWFPs management, utilization and marketing. ➤ Work in close coordination with other organizations, sectors and agencies, and seek assistance for the development of management group. ➤ To arrange and coordinate the marketing of NWFPs and handicraft items. ➤ Represent the group in meetings that will take place in other parts of the country and share information and ideas acquired from the meeting with the group members. ➤ Resolve disputes and conflicts arising among the group members and maintain good working relations. ➤ Coordinate the patrolling of NWFPs prevailing areas from time to time on rotational basis. ➤ Initiate annual planning and progress report submission to Gewog Forest Ranger and Chief Forest Officer through RO.

	➤ Jointly sign with the Secretary and Treasurer on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.
	Name of Secretary: Kinzang
Secretary	Responsibilities of Secretary: ➤ Officiate the chairperson in his absence. ➤ Inform the date, time and venue of meeting to all the group members. ➤ Keep minutes of NWFPs related meetings and make presentation at the end. ➤ Assist the chairperson in solving conflicts arising among members and maintain good working relations, and also in marketing of NWFPs. ➤ Keep proper record and data of NWFPs collected and marketed. ➤ Jointly sign with the Chairperson and Treasurer on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.
	Name of Treasurer: Chejay
Treasurer	Responsibilities of Treasurer: ➤ Keep proper records and accountings of NWFPs and assist the chairperson and secretary in marketing. ➤ Issue a receipt to the individual for quantity of NWFPs collected for sale. ➤ Keep annual financial transaction records and present to the group members during the general assembly. ➤ Collect and deposit the money in the NWFPs group account maintained with the nearest financial institution. ➤ Jointly sign with the Chairperson and Secretary on the cheque during the withdrawal of community fund.

13. Compensation to the executive committee

- The community has unanimously decided to do away with the payment of the compensation practice to the executive committee members for marketing services. The committee along with few group members will work on rotational basis for the benefit of all the community members without any incentives.

14. Membership fee and purpose

- Every member shall contribute annual membership fee of Nu. 50 (fifty) only. The amount will be deposited in the nearest bank and utilized the accumulated amount for the welfare of the NWFPs group members in the near future. The amount can even use for pre-financing the marketing cost of NWFPs.

15. Community development fund and utilization of fund

The community development fund will be generated through following means;

- Membership fees collection
- Sale of NWFPs like ferns, mushrooms, Damroo, *Rubia*, *Pouzolzia* species etc.
- 5% deduction of the total sale value of the NWFPs from every individual
- Fines and penalties of absentees and illegal collectors
- Contribution and donation from visitors and other relevant agencies.

The accumulated common fund will be managed & utilized for the welfare of group members as follows;

- The common fund generating from above means will maintain in the group saving account with the BDBL.
- Whether to give loan to the needy member or not will be decided during the annual general assembly and accordingly frame separate internal rules and regulations.
- The fund will be utilized for the procurement of office stationeries, seals, printing of permits books, money receipt etc.
- In order to meet the small internal expenses, either the chairperson or the secretary has authority to keep the community fund of Nu. 3000 (three thousand) only in their hands. For any further changes, the issue will discuss during the annual general assembly in future.

16. Conflict Resolution

- The chairperson and the secretary shall solve the conflict arising among the group members.
- If the conflict arises between executive committee members and the group members, the matter shall be forwarded to Chiwog Tshogpa followed by Gewog Forestry staff and Gewog Administration by chairperson for final decision.
- If the problem arises between group members and the outsiders, the matter shall directly forward to the Gewog Administration for settlement followed by Dzongkhag Administration if it is not solved at gewog level.

17. Penalties

Collection or harvesting of NWFPs for home consumption purposes will be free of royalty while for commercial purposes will face certain percentage deductions towards community development fund from the total sales of every individual. However, the fines and penalties against the illegal collectors will be imposed both for group members as well as non-members in the following ways;

Name of NWFPs	Fines and penalties for illegal collection
<i>Borinda grossa</i>	Nu. 5/ culm & seize
<i>Daphne</i> sp	Nu. 100 per kg & seize
Mushroom spp.	Nu. 200 per kg seize
Fern shoots	Nu. 15 per bundle & seize
Rubia spp. (Lanero)+ Yongjibu	Nu. 50 per kg & seize
<i>Viscum album</i>	Nu. 500 per kg & seize (Raw) Nu. 1000 per kg & seize (value added)
Harvesting from un-identified locations	Nu. 1000 & seize
If illegal collection of any NWFPs not listed in the mgt. plan	As per the FNCRR with kind support from the forestry officials
Other norms and penalties of the group members	
Misuse of fund by the executive committee members	Should repay the amount with existing bank interest rate
If any committee members fail to deliver service	Terminate him/her and appoint new ones through voting system
Failure to attend meeting	Nu.100
Failure to attend work	Nu. 300

Annexure I: List of NWFP group members

Sl. no.	Name	C.I.D. no.	Thram	House no.
1	Jamtsho	11102006330	474	NA-8-63
2	Youngmin	11102006341	475	NA-8-64
3	Tendel Zangmo	11102006369	494	NA-8-68
4	Lungten	11102006383	496	NA-8-69
5	YeshiChozom	11102006398	486	NA-8-70
6	KezangThinley	11102006415	980	NA-8-71
7	Namgay P.	11102006418	490/491	NA-8-72
8	NamgayWangchuk	11102006419	490/491	NA-8-72
9	KhotsaBogtong	11102006429	476	NA-8-73
10	Thukten	11102006439	490/491	NA-8-74
11	KelzangLhamo	11102006431	476	NA-8-73
12	KinzangChophel	11102006456	984	NA-8-76
13	TshewangDuba	11102006464	497	NA-8-77
14	Tshejay	11102006474	497	NA-8-78
15	NamgayWangdi	11102006478	801	NA-8-79
16	SangayWangdi	11102006485	47/903	NA-8-80

17	NamgayPhuntsho	11102006493	475	NA-8-81
18	KenchoWangmo	11102006502	467	NA-8-82
19	Tshewang Dorji	11102006514	477	NA-8-83
20	Cheyima	11102006521	SEPT-477	NA-8-84
21	MelamZangpo	11102006532	488/477	NA-8-85
22	TashiDargay	11102006551	473	NA-8-87
23	Ugyen Dorji	11102006557	469	NA-8-88
24	PemaJamtsho	11102006567	920	NA-8-91
25	Bodmo	11102006575	570	NA-8-92
26	Sherab	11102006581	952	NA-8-93
27	Karma Yonten	11102006594	405	NA-8-94
28	TashiGyelpo	11102006603	464	NA-8-96
29	SangayPenjor	11102006611	650	NA-8-97
30	Layda	11102006625	468	NA-8-98
31	TashiPenjor	11102006638	898	NA-8-99
32	TashiDuba	11102006646	483	NA-8-100
33	Jamtsho	11102006652	480	NA-8-101
34	Karma Jimpa	11102006674	463	NA-8-103
35	SherabChozom	11102006683	496	NA-8-104
36	Sherab Tenzin	11102006699	137	NA-8-105
37	TashiWangchuk	11102006715	496	NA-8-106
38	NimaGyelpo	11102006731	495	NA-8-108
39	Chache	11102006737	487/499	NA-8-109
40	Wangchuk	11102006747	895	NA-8-110
41	Dorji Wangchuk	11102006768	616	NA-8-112
42	Dodola	11102006776	981	NA-8-113
43	Bokshi	11102006784	827	NA-8-114
44	Jigme	11102006804	916	NA-8-117
45	KinzangLhadon	11102006817	826/482/831	NA-8-118
46	SangayWangchuk	11102006825	825/29	NA-8-120
47	TsheringChoda	11102006837	492/984	NA-8-122
48	PhuntshoNorbu	11102006845	828	NA-8-123
49	Taupo	11102006862	904	NA-8-125
50	Tobgay	11102005952	906/43	NA-8-127
51	PemaLhadon	11102005958	511/907	NA-8-128
52	SangayLhamo	11102005965	905	NA-8-129
53	PhuntshoWangchuk	11102000608	498	NA-8-132

54	NorbuGyeltshen	11102000613	506	NA-8-133
55	Sumgay	11102000532	572	NA-8-135
56	TshewangJamtsho	11102000685	SEPT-789	NA-8-142
57	TashiZangmo	11102000696	739	NA-8-145
58	Namgay B.	11102000702	500	NA-8-146
59	Dubchu	11102006665	555	NA-8-410
60	Duki	11102006411	4	Na-8-404
61	ChotenWangchuk	11102006584	422	Na-8-399
62	SangayPhuntsho	11102006767	467	Na-8-398
63	KelzangWangmo	11102006533	534	Na-8-396
64	Tshering Dorji	11102005947	510	Na-8-352
65	SangayWangmo	1110200		
66	Yonten Dorji	11102006805	416	NA-8-363
67	NimaJatsho	1110200		
68	TheringDendup	11102000684	5	NA-8-682
69	CheytenWangmo	11102000653	789	NA-8-138